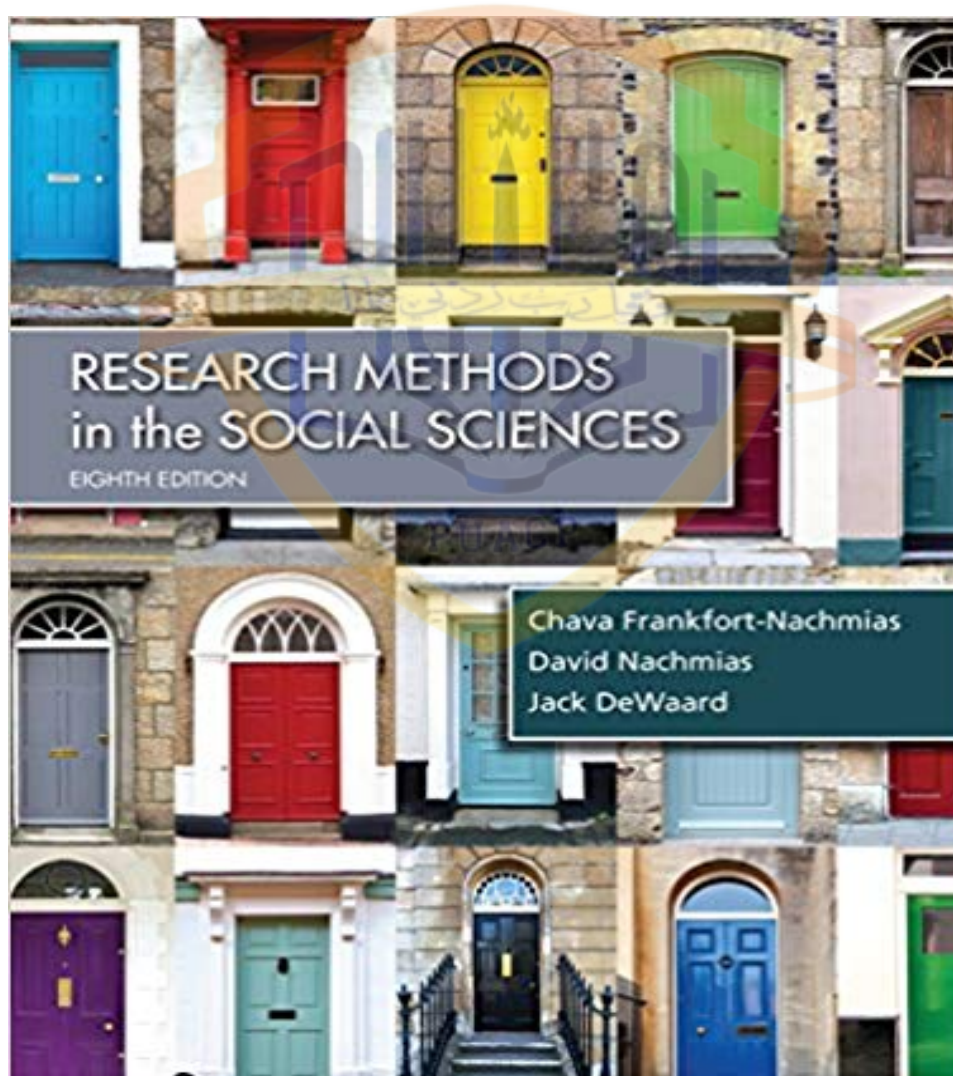


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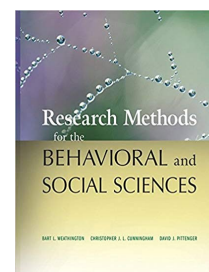
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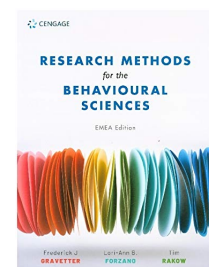
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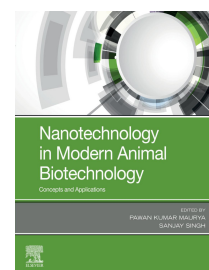
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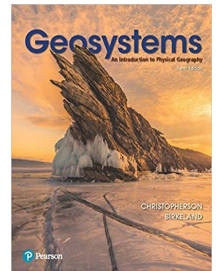
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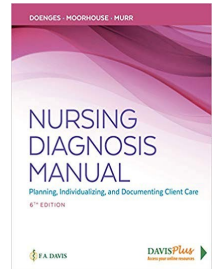
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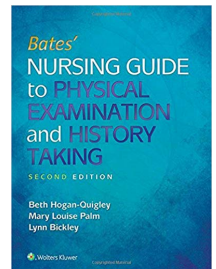
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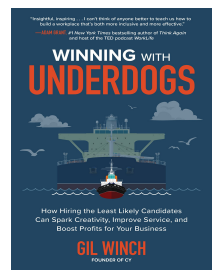
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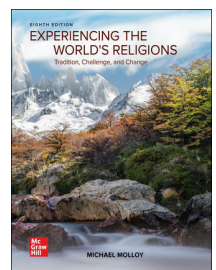
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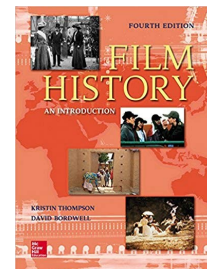
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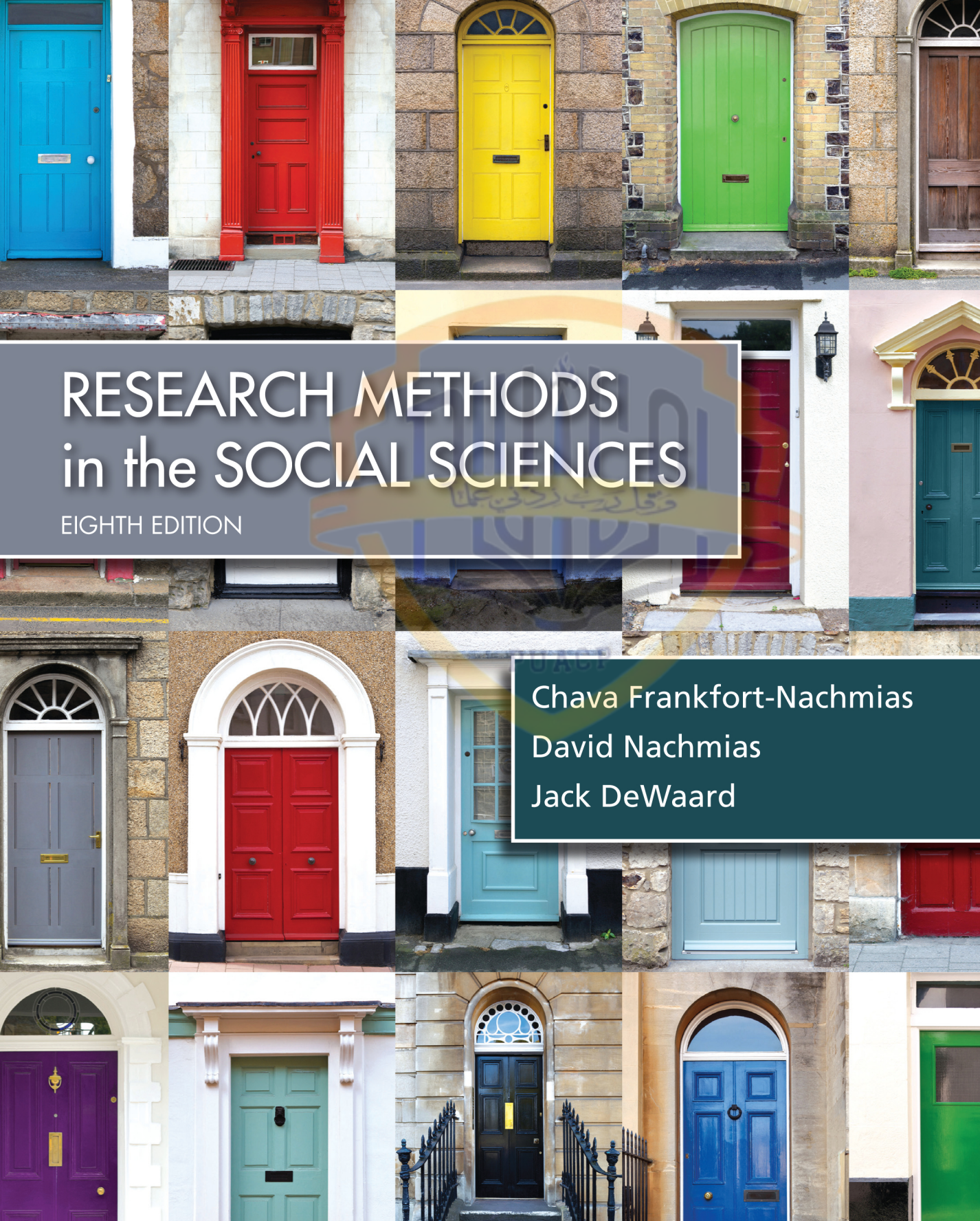


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RESEARCH METHODS in the SOCIAL SCIENCES

EIGHTH EDITION

Chava Frankfort-Nachmias
David Nachmias
Jack DeWaard



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Preface

The goal of the eighth edition of *Research Methods in the Social Sciences*, as in the previous editions, is to offer a comprehensive, systematic presentation of the scientific approach within the context of the social sciences. We emphasize the relationship among theory, research, and practice and integrate research activities in an orderly framework so that the reader can more easily learn about the nature of social sciences research.

In our view, social sciences research is a cyclical, self-correcting process consisting of seven major interrelated stages: definition of the research problem, statement of the hypothesis, research design, measurement, data collection, data analysis, and generalization. Each of these stages is interrelated with theory. The text leads the reader through each stage of this process.

The New Edition

The new edition continues to blend a broad range of classic social sciences research studies with up-to-date examples of contemporary social sciences issues. The additions and changes reflect developments in the field since publication of the previous edition. Major updates and revisions to the eighth edition include the following:

- New Part Openers preview the concepts covered in each of the four major sections of the book.
- Lengthier chapters from the previous edition have been streamlined to highlight central concepts.
- Current and interdisciplinary examples draw from a range of social sciences disciplines, including anthropology, economics, geography, history, political science, psychology, public policy, and sociology, among others.
- Expanded coverage of research methods in the digital age, including the use of the Internet and various computer software packages for retrieving, cleaning, coding, and analyzing “big data.”
- Expanded coverage of qualitative research methods, most especially of participant observation and ethnography.

The following updates and revisions have likewise been implemented in each chapter:

- New chapter introductions illustrate the central themes in each chapter, drawing on current topics and research studies, including the use of Twitter feeds in social sciences research, the 2011 revolutions in Egypt and Tunisia (i.e., the “Arab Spring”), and climate change.
- Updated research examples are provided throughout each chapter.
- Chapter examples using data from the General Social Survey (GSS) have been updated to reflect data from the 2012 round of the GSS.
- Expanded “Study Questions” are provided at the end of each chapter.
- New end-of-chapter exercises on “Reading and Writing Research Reports” help students understand and apply chapter concepts to the practice and process of social sciences research.

The Plan of This Book

The book's organization progresses logically from the conceptual and theoretical building blocks of the research process to data analysis and computer applications, offering students a comprehensive and systematic foundation for comprehending the breadth and depth of social sciences research. The book's self-contained yet integrated chapters promote flexibility in structuring courses depending upon the individual instructor's needs and interests. The text adapts easily to two kinds of courses: a basic research methods course or one that covers research methods and statistics sequentially.

Chapter 1 examines the foundations of knowledge, the objectives of scientific research, and the basic assumptions of the scientific approach. Chapters 2 and 3 discuss the basic issues of empirical research and the relationship between theory and research. They cover the topics of concept formation, the roles and types of theories, models, variables, and hypothesis construction. Chapter 4 focuses on ethical concerns in social sciences research and considers ways to ensure the rights and the welfare of research participants, including the right to privacy.

Chapters 5 and 6 present the research design stage. A research design is a strategy that guides investigators; it is a logical model for inferring causal relations. Experimental designs are discussed and illustrated in Chapter 5, and quasi- and pre-experimental designs are examined in Chapter 6. Chapter 7 is concerned with measurement and quantification. The issues of validity and reliability—inseparable from measurement theory—are also reviewed here, together with the issue of measurement error. In Chapter 8, we present the principles of sampling theory, the most frequently used sampling designs, and the methods for estimating sample size.

In Chapters 9 through 13, we present and illustrate the various methods of data collection available to social scientists. A discussion of observational methods, including laboratory experiments, field experiments, and natural experiments, as well as the importance of triangulation are the subjects of Chapter 9. Survey research—particularly the mail questionnaire, the personal interview, the telephone interview, and the online survey—is examined in Chapter 10. Chapter 11 describes and illustrates methods of questionnaire construction: the content of questions, types of questions, question format, and the sequence of questions. Chapter 12 is devoted to the theory and practice of qualitative research, with a particular emphasis on participant observation and field research. In Chapter 13, we discuss secondary data analysis—its utility and limitations, private and public sources of secondary data, methods for searching, and content analysis.

The subsequent five chapters are concerned with data processing and analysis. In Chapter 14, we present techniques of codebook construction, coding schemes and devices, ways to prepare data for analysis, the use of data-analysis software in social sciences research, and communication network linkages. Chapter 15 introduces the univariate distribution, measures of central tendency and dispersion, and various types of frequency distributions. Chapter 16 examines bivariate analysis, focusing on the relationship between two variables. Multivariate analysis is the subject of Chapter 17, which presents ways of analyzing multiple variables with various statistical procedures. Chapter 18 presents common techniques used in constructing indexes and scales; and in Chapter 19, we discuss strategies of hypothesis testing, levels of significance, regions of rejection, and parametric and nonparametric tests of significance.

This text, together with the supporting materials, will help readers move through the major stages of the research process.

Student Online Resources

For the eighth edition, we have created a companion website to allow students easier and more comprehensive access to resources and study aids. The online student resources provide the following study aids for each chapter: Chapter Abstract, Learning Objectives, Key Terms, Flashcards, Web Quizzes, General Social Survey Data Sets, and more.

We have moved a number of elements in the previous edition of the text to the companion website, such as the “Introduction to SPSS” (formerly Appendix A) now found there. This introduction guides students through preparing and executing data analysis using this widely available and often-used software package. The “Additional Reading” sections at the end of each chapter in the previous edition are now located on the companion website as well. The “Sources for Research and Hypotheses” section at the end of Chapter 3 in the previous edition has also been moved online. This section contains a fully revised and updated listing of some of the most useful and current bibliographies, indexes, journals, and statistical source books available for conducting social research.

Instructor Resources

The Instructor Resources to accompany *Research Methods in The Social Sciences* have been expanded in the eighth edition revision. New resources include a Research Spotlight, which provides current and provocative empirical exemplars to illustrate the themes in each chapter and can be used for additional content, discussions, and student readings; new PowerPoint lecture slides for each chapter; and an expanded Test Bank. The Instructor Resources also contain Essay and Discussion Questions, Research Projects, and more.

Acknowledgments

Our literary debts are testified to throughout the text. Many students, instructors, reviewers, and colleagues have offered useful ideas and comments since the first edition was published.

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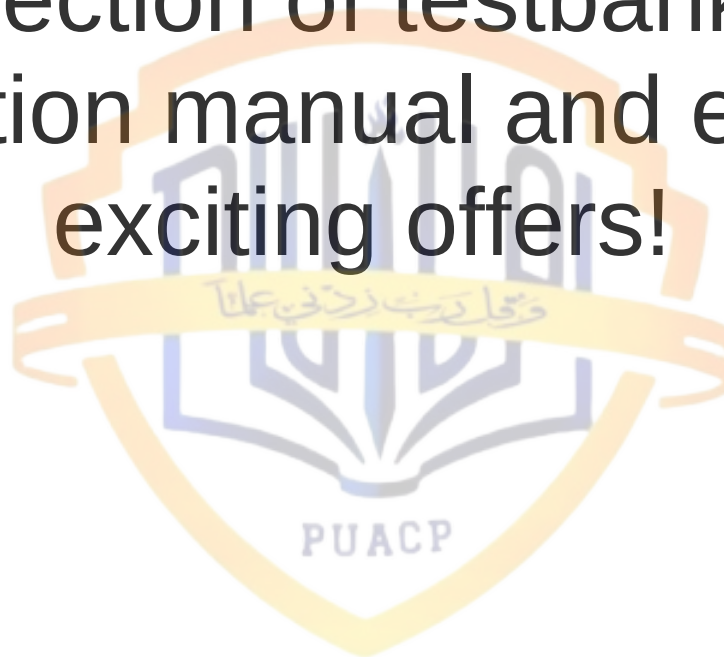
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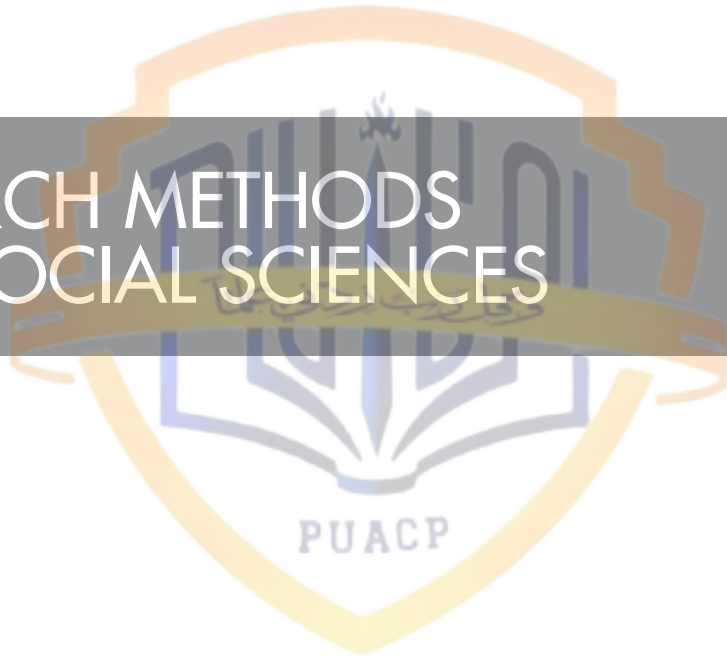
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RESEARCH METHODS in the SOCIAL SCIENCES





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PART I

FOUNDATIONS OF EMPIRICAL RESEARCH

The chapters in this book are grouped into four parts. Together, they illustrate the sequential and often cyclical steps involved in social sciences research. In Part I, we are concerned with the foundations of empirical research in the social sciences. What are these foundations? The short answer is that there are many foundations. A more involved answer is that the foundations of social research are not only diverse but also highly integrated (that is, whole).

Social research cannot and should not be understood or undertaken without reference to early and vigorous debates in the philosophy of science, formal logic, and consideration of different forms of logical reasoning (Chapter 1). Nor can social sciences research occur without a common language in the form of clear and mutually agreed upon concepts, definitions, theories, and models (Chapter 2). To make the connection between the conceptual and observational worlds, social scientists must be equally rigorous in translating the above into a defined set of operations and procedures to specify variables and hypotheses, measure and assess associations, and, ultimately, generate knowledge (Chapter 3). With knowledge creation and dissemination also come important responsibilities with respect to the ethical conduct of research, including protecting research subjects and conducting research and reporting results honestly and openly (Chapter 4).



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CHAPTER 1

THE SCIENTIFIC APPROACH

- ⦿ WHAT IS SCIENCE?
- ⦿ APPROACHES TO KNOWLEDGE
- ⦿ BASIC ASSUMPTIONS OF SCIENCE
- ⦿ AIMS OF THE SOCIAL SCIENCES
 - Scientific Explanation
 - Prediction
 - Understanding
- ⦿ THE ROLES OF METHODOLOGY
 - Rules for Communication
 - Rules for Reasoning
 - Rules for Intersubjectivity
- ⦿ SCIENTIFIC REVOLUTIONS
 - Normal Science
 - Revolutionary Science
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- ⦿ THE RESEARCH PROCESS
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